A Stiffly backwards ears

Not present (0)	Moderately present (1)	Obviously present (2)

The ears are held stiffly and turned backwards. As a result, the space between the ears may appear wider relative to baseline.

B Orbital tightening

Not present (0)	Moderately present (1)	Obviously present (2)

The eyelid is partially or completely closed. Any eyelid closure that reduces the eye size by more than half should be coded as “obviously present” or “2”.

C Tension above the eye area

Not present (0)	Moderately present (1)	Obviously present (2)

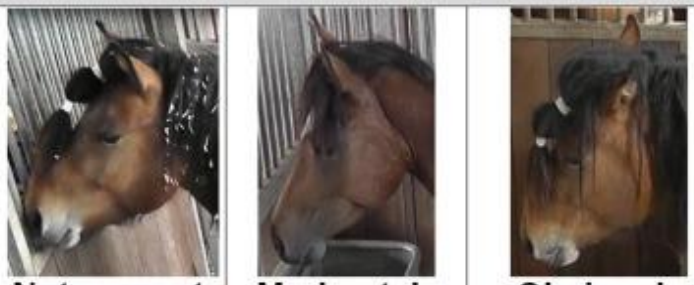
The contraction of the muscles in the area above the eye causes the increased visibility of the underlying bone surfaces. If temporal crest bone is clearly visible should be coded as “obviously present” or “2”.

D Prominent strained chewing muscles

Not present (0)	Moderately present (1)	Obviously present (2)

Straining chewing muscles are clearly visible as an increase tension above the mouth. If chewing muscles are clearly prominent and recognizable the score should be coded as “obviously present” or “2”.

E Mouth strained and pronounced chin



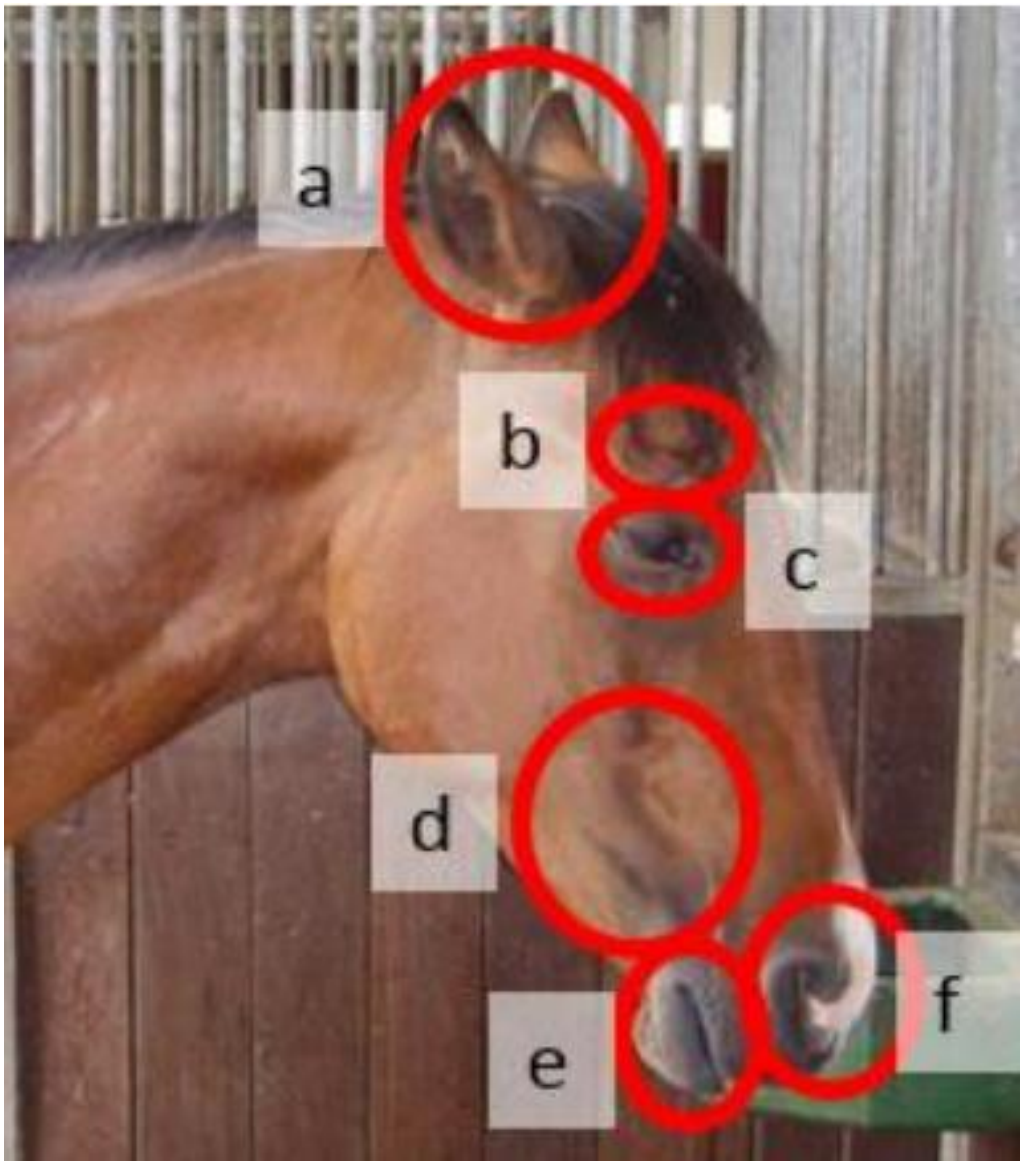
Not present (0)	Moderately present (1)	Obviously present (2)

Strained mouth is clearly visible when upper lip is drawn back and lower lip causes a pronounced “chin”.

F Strained nostrils and flattening of the profile

Not present (0)	Moderately present (1)	Obviously present (2)

Nostrils look strained and slightly dilated, the profile of the nose flattens and lips elongate.



Each facial feature (6 altogether) is scored 0-1-2 (normal-moderate-severe). Thus, horse gets something between 0-12 points. Total score is then calculated and pain score is given- Total score 0-3 points= low/normal, 4-7 points = moderate pain, >7= severe pain.